

Vanessa Yee-kwan Wong

Curriculum Vitae

Department of East Asian Studies

University of California, Irvine

✉ yeekw [at] uci.edu 🌐 yeekw.github.io

Education

University of California, Irvine

2020 – 2026 (Expected)

PhD candidate, East Asian Studies

Committee: Bert Scruggs (Chair), Ackbar Abbas, Hu Ying, Jeffrey N. Wasserstrom

Dissertation: “Racial Ambiguity in Modern Chinese Literature”

Indiana University Bloomington

2017 – 2020

MA in Chinese Pedagogy

M.A. Project: “Evaluating Culture Instruction in Third-year Film Discussion Class”

Chinese University of Hong Kong

2013 – 2017

BA in Linguistics (First-class Honor)

Publications

Journal articles:

1. “An Untranslatable Hong Kong story: Wong Bik-wan’s ‘Nausea.’” *Writing Chinese: A Journal of Contemporary Sinophone Literature*, vol. 2, no. 1, 2023, p. 106-122.
<http://doi.org/10.22599/wcj.46> 🔗
2. “From Passing to Mixing: Racial Ambiguity in Jin Yong’s Anti-Manchu Novels.” *Journal of Asian Studies* (Under review).

Book chapters:

1. “The Poetics of Water in Dung Kai-cheung’s (Meta-)apocalyptic Tale,” in Kwai-cheung Lo and Hung-chiung Li (eds), *Entangled Waterscapes in Asia*, Leiden: Brill, 2025, pp. 136-152.
<https://doi.org/10.1163/9789004719170009> 🔗
2. “Trauma of the Other: A Study of Wu Ming-yi’s *The Route of Sleep* (2007),” in Géraldine Fiss and Wendy Sun (eds), *Retelling Trauma and Imagining Catastrophe in the Modern Chinese and Sinophone World*, Amsterdam University Press (Under review).

Translations:

1. “Nausea” by Wong Bik-wan, in *Cha: An Asian Literary Journal*, April 14, 2024.
<https://chajournal.blog/2024/04/14/nausea/> 🔗
2. “Island” by Lai Hsiang-yin, in *Taiwan Literature: English Translation Series*, 50, pp. 143-159.
https://press.ntu.edu.tw/en/publish/show.php?act=book&refer=tup_book01313 🔗
3. “The Development of Taiwan Literary Studies in North America: Taking the Society for the Study of Taiwan Literature and Taiwan Literature: English Translation Series as Examples” by Li-hsuan Chang, in *Taiwan Literature: English Translation Series*, 48, pp. 91-111.
https://press.ntu.edu.tw/en/publish/show.php?act=bookrefer=ntup_book01247 🔗

Pedagogy Training and Professionalization

California State University PRE-Professor Program (PREPP)	2025
UC Irvine Mentoring Excellence Certificate	2024
UC Irvine Grant-Writing and Research Development Institute	2023
UC Irvine Division of Teaching Excellence and Innovation (DTEI) Certificate	2021
American Council on the Teaching of foreign Languages (ACTFL) Oral Proficiency Interview (OPI) Certificate Workshop at Indiana University Bloomington	2018
Washington University in St Louis-ALLEX Chinese and Japanese Teacher Training Institute	2017

Teaching Experience

Lecturer , University of California, Irvine	Summer 2024
○ Course taught: <i>Hong Kong Cinema</i> ○ Independently designed syllabus and delivered lectures ○ Earned a 97.2% overall approval rating from 12 students ○ Commended for interactive teaching style and in-depth film analysis	
Teaching Assistant , University of California, Irvine	2021 - 2025
○ Courses taught: <i>First-year and Second-year Chinese, Introduction to East Asian Religions, Chinese Science Fiction, Love in the May Fourth, Chinese Regionalism, Postcolonial Taiwan, City and World Cinema, Korean Cinema, Japanese History through Popular Culture</i> ○ Led weekly discussion sessions and modeled close reading and analytical strategies ○ Assisted in designing course assignments, exams, and grading rubrics ○ Provided individualized writing consultations for term papers and final projects	
Drill Instructor , Indiana University Bloomington - Flagship Chinese Institute	2018 - 2020
○ Courses taught: <i>Second-year Chinese, Fourth-year Chinese (online)</i> ○ Developed original instructional materials for Fourth-year Chinese drill classes ○ Led weekly Chinese Singing Club to promote language learning through hobbies and cultural literacy	
Associate Instructor , Indiana University Bloomington	2017-2020
○ Courses taught: <i>First-year Chinese, Third-Year Chinese, Advanced Chinese Seminar (Topics in Humanities, Topics in Social Sciences)</i> ○ Conducted drill sections, pronunciation tutorials, and ACTFL OPI practice sections ○ Produced and peer-reviewed teaching materials in weekly lesson plan meetings ○ Initiated a three-part film discussion series to reinforce cultural competence ○ Mentored Flagship students on study-abroad preparation and independent research projects in Chinese ○ Coordinated cultural activities at bi-weekly Chinese Table	

Invited Talks

1. "Lou Ye's *Suzhou River*," Guest lecture for "EAS 160: China on Screen," UC Irvine; May 15, 2025.
2. "Views of the Afterlife in Chinese Religions," Guest lecture for "Views of the Afterlife," California State University East Bay; April 28, 2025.
3. "Garden as a Metaphor in Li Ang's *Lost Garden*," Guest lecture for "EAS 155: Postcolonial Taiwan," UC Irvine; April 18, 2025.
4. "Edward Yang's *A Confucian Confusion*," Guest lecture for "EAS 55: Uses of Tradition," UC Irvine; March 6, 2025.
5. "Ding Ling's *Yecao*," Guest lecture for "EAS 110: Love in the May Fourth," UC Irvine; February 13, 2024.
6. "Dung Kai-cheung's *Atlas*," Three-part lecture series for "EAS 155: Chinese Regionalism," UC Irvine; March 15-20, 2023.
7. "Texts and Inter-texts from the Democratic Movements in Hong Kong," Chinese Tidings Lecture Series, Indiana University Bloomington; November 6, 2019.
8. "Invitation to Cantonese," World Language Festival, Indiana University Bloomington; October 6, 2018.

Selected Conference Presentations

1. "Trauma of the Other: A Study of Wu Ming-yi's *The Route of Sleep* (2007)," Association for Asian Studies Annual Conference, Columbus, OH, March 19, 2025.
2. "From Passing to Mixing: Manchu/Han Identities in Jin Yong's Novels," Modern Language Association Annual Convention, New Orleans, LA, January 12, 2025.
3. "Racial Ambiguity and Maternal Alienation in Eileen Chang's 'Chained Links' (1944)," Rocky Mountain Modern Language Association Annual Convention, Las Vegas, NV, October 11, 2024.
4. "What is Central to Hong Kong: Qian Mali's *The Woman in Kenzo* (1977-1984)," Association for Asian Studies Annual Conference, Seattle, WA, March 16, 2024.
5. "Disappearing City, Disappearing Women: Wong Bik-wan's 'Shi Cheng,'" Association for Asian Studies Annual Conference, Boston, MA, March 17, 2023.
6. "Written on Water: Seaside Libraries in Wu Ming-yi and Dung Kai-cheung's Novels," American Comparative Literature Association Annual Meeting, Virtual event, June 18, 2022.

University Service

Committee Member, Scholarship Endorsement Committee

2024

- Coordinated campus nomination meetings and interviewed applicants for the Fulbright English Teaching Assistantship (ETA) and Schwarzman Scholars Program (Tsinghua University, Beijing)
- Drafted campus endorsement letters and provided detailed feedback to applicants

Graduate Scholar, UC Irvine Scholarship Opportunities Program

2023-2024

- Advised students on application strategies for prestigious external scholarships
- Organized scholarship information sessions and skill-building workshops
- Collaborated with staff in weekly planning meetings for campus-wide outreach initiatives

Graduate Consultant , Cine-Collective	2024
◦ Mentored undergraduate film club organizers in event planning and programming	
Student Organizer , UC Irvine School of Humanities	2023
◦ Facilitated the 2023 UC Irvine Forum for the Academy and the Public	
Student Organizer , Indianapolis Chinese Language and Culture Fair	2018
◦ Coordinated Chinese speech contests and cultural activities for community participants	

Selected Grants and Fellowships

UC Irvine Tien Family Dissertation Fellowship, \$30000	2025
UC Irvine School of Humanities Summer Dissertation Fellowship, \$5000	2025
UC Irvine International Center for Writing and Translation Publication Support Grant, \$1000	2024
Long U.S.-China Institute Graduate Student Research Grant, \$2000	2023
Center of Asian Studies Graduate Student Travel Grant, \$1000	2022
Division of Teaching Excellence and Innovation (DTEI) Summer Graduate Fellowship, \$5000	2020
UC Irvine Regents' Fellowship, \$25000	2020

Languages

Cantonese (Native), Mandarin (Near native), Japanese (Intermediate), Biblical Hebrew and German (Reading)

Professional Memberships

Association for Asian Studies (AAS), Modern Language Association (MLA), Chinese Language Teachers Association (CLTA)